transmittable to humans. Example: Fasciola species.

- **Accidental parasite:** This parasite infect an unusual host are known as accidental parasites. Example: *Echinococcus granulosus* infects man accidentally.
- **Wandering or Aberrant parasites:** Parasites which infect a host migrate to the site where it cannot live or develop further are called aberrant parasites. Example: Dog roundworm infecting humans.

8.1.3 Types of Host

Definite host: The host which harbour the adult parasites or where parasites undergo sexual method of reproduction is referred to as a definite host. The definite host may be a human or any other living organism. Example: Mosquito acts as a definite host for *Plasmodium* spp. in Malaria.

Intermediate host: The host in which the larval stages of the parasite live or where asexual reproduction takes place is called the intermediate host. Example: Man acts as an intermediate host for *Plasmodium* spp. in Malaria.

Reservoir host: The host which harbour the parasite and acts has an important source of infection to other susceptible hosts is known as reservoir host. It is also called temporary host. Example: Dog is the reservoir host for disease kala azar.

Natural host: The host which is naturally infected with a certain species of parasite, is called natural host. Example: Pig is the natural host of *Balantidium coli*.

Paratenic host or transport host: some parasites enter a host in which they do not undergo any development but remains alive till they gain entry into the definitive host or intermediate host. Such a host is termed as paratenic host or transport host or carrier host.



Common name of medically important parasite

Intestinal flagellates – *Giardia intestinalis*

Oral Flagellates – *Trichomonas tenax*

Genital flagellates – *Trichomonas vaginalis*

Blood and Tissue flagellates – *Leishmania and Trypanosoma*

Ciliated protozoa – *Balantidium coli*

Dog roundworm – *Toxocara canis*

Cat roundworm – *Toxocara cati*

Roundworm – *Ascaris lumbricoides*

Hookworm – *Ancylostoma duodenale*

Liver fluke – *Fasciola hepatica*

Blood fluke – *Schistosoma haematobium*

Lung fluke – *Paragonimus westermani*

Pork tapeworm – *Taenia solium*

Beef tapeworm – *Taenia saginata*

Eyeworm – *Thelazia spp*

Threadworm or Human pinworm – *Enterobius vermicularis*

Human whipworm – *Trichuris trichiura*

8.1.4 Classification of Medically Parasitology

The most acceptable taxonomic classification of human parasites includes Endoparasites and Ectoparasite. Endoparasites are subclassified into protozoan parasite (unicellular organisms) and helminthic parasite (multicellular

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